

DAYS 1-60

Read the program, then install the common protocol.

Outcome by day 60

A shared evidence-based view of the four-workstream portfolio, explicit decision rights, a reconciled roadmap and budget narrative, visible dependencies, and a lightweight governance cadence that teams can use without slowing legitimate scientific and technical work.

DAYS 1-30 · READ THE PROGRAM

Stakeholder and authority map

- Confirm sponsors, steering members, R&D scientific owners, data scientists, ML engineers, Digital/IT, architecture, security, privacy, quality/compliance, finance, change partners, procurement, and vendors.
- Document decision rights, escalation paths, forum purposes, and required pre-reads.

Portfolio truth

- Reconcile roadmap, backlog, milestones, budget baseline, actuals, forecast, resource plan, risks, issues, assumptions, dependencies, and value hypotheses.
- Separate missing evidence from conflicting versions of truth.

Delivery-system observation

- Attend ceremonies and governance forums before changing them.
- Map handoffs, queueing, blocked work, work-in-progress, rework, and time lost waiting for decisions.

DELIVERABLES BY DAY 30

Artifact	Purpose	Acceptance signal
Portfolio baseline	One reconciled view of roadmap, spend, workstream status, dependencies, and decision needs	Owners agree it is accurate enough to govern
Decision-rights map	Clarify who recommends, decides, approves, executes, and is informed	No recurring decision lacks a named authority
Governance-friction log	Separate necessary controls from avoidable waiting and duplicate reporting	Top friction patterns acknowledged by teams and sponsors

DAYS 31-60 · INSTALL THE PROTOCOL

Mechanism	What changes	Why it matters
AI Portfolio Protocol	Each workstream maintains value, readiness, authority, spend, dependencies, and adoption ownership	Steering decisions compare like-for-like evidence without flattening methods
Decision-led steering	Pre-reads lead with exceptions, tradeoffs, forecast movement, and decisions required	Executive time produces commitments rather than status narration
Integrated roadmap	Milestones show cross-workstream and enterprise dependencies, not only team dates	Critical-path risk appears earlier
Budget confidence view	Actuals, forecast, assumptions, ranges, and trigger points are visible	Uncertainty becomes governable rather than hidden
Change evidence	Users, workflow changes, enablement, feedback, and sustainment owners join delivery evidence	Adoption is engineered before launch
Risk/issue discipline	Risks link to owners, triggers, mitigations, decisions, and due dates	Risk registers drive action rather than archival reporting

AGILE COACHING STANCE

Use Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, or hybrid practices as means, not identity. Preserve what helps teams learn and deliver; remove ceremonies that do not change priorities, unblock work, improve quality, or create learning. Measure flow and decision quality before declaring maturity.

DELIVERABLES BY DAY 60

- Accepted protocol vocabulary and common status definitions
- Revised steering cadence and concise executive readout
- Integrated dependency and decision log
- Budget/forecast narrative with assumptions and escalation triggers
- Change/adoption evidence embedded in each workstream

DAYS 61-90

Prove the cadence through real decisions and transfer ownership.

Outcome by day 90

The portfolio operating system has survived real workstream decisions, exposed its weak points, improved sponsor confidence, and begun transferring into durable client capability for the remaining engagement horizon.

ACTIONS

Run decision rehearsals

Use upcoming sponsor decisions to test evidence quality, authority clarity, budget confidence, dependency readiness, adoption ownership, and the usefulness of the forum.

Retire low-value reporting

Remove duplicate status fields and meetings that do not affect a decision, risk, commitment, forecast, or learning loop.

Transfer ownership

Pair each mechanism with a named owner, operating instructions, examples, acceptance criteria, and a feedback cadence.

EXECUTIVE SCORECARD CATEGORIES

Category	Question	Evidence type
Value	Is the outcome hypothesis clearer and more supportable?	Verified baseline, user evidence, business/scientific measure
Flow	Are work and decisions moving with less avoidable waiting?	Blocked time, dependency aging, decision latency
Confidence	Does leadership understand forecast and uncertainty?	Actuals, range, assumptions, variance narrative
Trust	Are authority, quality, privacy, and compliance controls explicit?	Decision rights, evaluations, exceptions, signoffs
Adoption	Is the capability becoming part of real R&D work?	Usage, workflow integration, feedback, sustainment owner
Learning	Does one workstream improve the next?	Reusable patterns, rejected assumptions, changed standards

TRANSFER PACKAGE

- Portfolio protocol guide and definitions
- Steering pre-read and decision-record templates
- Roadmap, dependency, budget, risk, and change conventions
- Facilitation notes and coaching prompts
- Examples of advance, re-plan, escalate, hold, and stop decisions
- Owner map and operating calendar

DURABLE CAPABILITY TEST

- Teams can explain which evidence must mature next
- Sponsors can distinguish status from a decision request
- Budget changes have assumptions, ranges, and action triggers
- Dependencies have owners and explicit consequences
- Adoption ownership exists before launch
- Lessons from one workstream alter the next

DAY-90 REVIEW

Present what changed, which decisions improved, which mechanisms earned continued use, what should stop, what remains uncertain, and the next-quarter priorities. No invented maturity score; the evidence itself is the report.